

USER INTERFACE AND USER EXPERIENCE DESIGN LAB

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EXPERIMENT -1

Bad Design 1: Service Elevator Signage

Description:

A service elevator with a temporary paper notice indicating the accessible floors. The signage is not prominent and may confuse users.

Source of Photograph:



Place:

PRP Building, VIT University, Vellore.

Reasons why the design is bad:

- Temporary paper sign looks unprofessional.
- Information is difficult to read from a distance.
- Poor visibility of service floor details.
- Lack of proper wayfinding signs.
- Overall appearance is not user-friendly.

Suggested Improvement:

- Install permanent signboards.
- Use larger fonts with better contrast.
- Improve lighting around the elevator.
- Include directional signs for easy navigation.

Bad Design 2: Parking Area**Description:**

A parking area where motorcycles and bicycles are parked together without proper markings or designated parking spaces.

Source of Photograph:

Place:

Beside Silver Jubilee Tower, VIT University, Vellore

Reasons why the design is bad:

- Parking spaces are not clearly marked.
- Vehicles are parked in an unorganized manner.
- No separate area for bicycles and motorcycles.
- Lack of directional signage.
- Difficult to maintain orderly parking.

Suggested Improvement:

- Paint clear parking slot markings.
- Separate bicycle and motorcycle parking zones.
- Install parking direction boards.
- Add parking regulations signage.
- Improve overall organization of the parking area.

Bad Design 3: Water Dispenser Area**Description:**

A drinking water dispenser with two taps but without any labels indicating which tap provides hot water and which provides cold water, making it difficult for users to identify the correct tap.

Source of Photography:

Place:

VIT University, Vellore – Drinking Water Station

Reasons Why This Design is Bad:

- The taps are not labeled, causing confusion for users.
- Users may accidentally dispense hot water instead of cold water, leading to a risk of burns.
- First-time visitors cannot easily identify the purpose of each tap.
- Reduces usability and increases the chance of user errors.
- The absence of clear visual guidance makes the dispenser less user-friendly.

Suggested Improvement:

- Add clear "Hot Water" and "Cold Water" labels above each tap using distinct colors (red for hot and blue for cold).
- Use durable, waterproof stickers or engraved labels for long-term visibility.
- Include warning symbols or a "Caution: Hot Water" sign near the hot water tap to prevent accidental burns.
- Add Braille or tactile markings to improve accessibility for visually impaired users.
- Use color-coded tap handles to make identification even easier.

Bad Design 4: Exposed False Ceiling**Description:**

A corridor with missing false ceiling panels, exposing HVAC ducts, electrical wiring, and other building services.

Source of Photograph:



Place:

PRP Building,VIT University, Vellore

Reasons why the design is bad:

- Exposed ducts and wiring reduce aesthetics.
- Ceiling appears unfinished.
- Dust can accumulate on exposed utilities.
- May raise safety and maintenance concerns.
- Creates a poor first impression of the building.

Suggested Improvement:

- Replace the missing ceiling panels.
- Conceal ducts and electrical wiring.
- Perform regular maintenance inspections.
- Repair damaged ceiling sections promptly.
- Maintain a clean and finished corridor appearance.

EXPERIMENT-2

Jugaad Design 1: Dedicated Lift Service Information Board

Description:

A lift entrance with a clearly displayed notice indicating that the lift serves only specific floors (G, 1, 3, 5, and 7). This informs users before entering and helps avoid unnecessary waiting.

Source of Photograph:



Place: VIT University, Vellore – SJT Building

Why is it a Jugaad?

- Provides clear information before using the lift.
- Reduces confusion among users.
- Helps manage lift traffic efficiently.
- Easy to read from a distance.
- Improves overall navigation inside the building.

Benefits:

- Saves users' time.
- Reduces unnecessary lift usage.
- Improves traffic flow.
- Enhances user experience.
- Supports efficient building management.

Suggested Improvement:

- Use larger, high-contrast lettering.
- Add directional arrows for alternative lifts or staircases.
- Display the information digitally with multilingual support.

Jugaad Design 2: Clearly Marked Car Parking Area

Description:

A parking area with a prominently displayed CAR PARKING sign that clearly identifies the designated parking space for cars, helping users park in the correct location.

Source of Photograph:



Place: VIT University, Vellore – Near Silver Jubilee Tower

Why is it a Jugaad?

- Clearly identifies the designated parking area.
- Easy to notice due to bright colors.
- Helps organize vehicle parking.
- Reduces parking confusion.
- Improves traffic management.

Benefits:

- Saves time for drivers.

- Prevents improper parking.
- Improves safety.
- Makes navigation easier.
- Maintains an organized parking area.

Suggested Improvement:

- Add directional arrows leading to the parking area.
- Include parking capacity information.
- Reserve and clearly mark accessible parking spaces.

Jugaad Design 3: Hot and Cold Water Dispenser with Clear Labels

Description:

A drinking water dispenser with two separate taps clearly labeled HOT WATER and COLD WATER using color-coded stickers. This allows users to quickly identify the correct tap and safely dispense water.

Source of Photograph:



Place: VIT University, Vellore – SJT Building

Why is it a Jugaad?

- Uses clear color-coded labels (Red for Hot, Blue for Cold).
- Reduces the chances of users selecting the wrong tap.
- Easy to understand without any instructions.
- Improves user safety by preventing accidental burns.
- Provides an intuitive and user-friendly interface.

Benefits:

- Enhances user convenience.
- Improves safety.
- Reduces confusion.
- Suitable for first-time users.
- Encourages quick and error-free usage.

Suggested Improvement:

- Add Braille labels for visually impaired users.
- Use larger font size for better visibility.
- Install an indicator light showing water temperature.
- Use bilingual or multilingual signage.
- Add safety symbols or pictograms.
- Install reflective signage for better visibility in low-light conditions.

Jugaad Design 4: Service Access Panel with Restricted Access Sign

Description:

A ceiling-mounted service access panel clearly labeled "SERVICE ACCESS PANEL – AUTHORISED PERSONNEL ONLY", informing users that the area is restricted to maintenance staff.

Source of Photograph:



Place: VIT University, Vellore – Academic Building Corridor

Why is it a Jugaad?

- Clearly communicates restricted access.
- Prevents unauthorized entry.
- Uses a visible and easy-to-read warning sign.
- Improves workplace safety.
- Helps protect maintenance equipment.

Benefits:

- Reduces accident risks.

- Protects critical infrastructure. Use bilingual or multilingual signage.
- Add safety symbols or pictograms.
- Install reflective signage for better visibility in low-light conditions.
- Improves safety awareness.
- Assists maintenance personnel.
- Ensures compliance with safety practices.

Suggested Improvement:

- Use bilingual or multilingual signage.
- Add safety symbols or pictograms.
- Install reflective signage for better visibility in low-light conditions.